

Obsidian for Beginners: Journal and Track Tasks

Key Takeaways

Task 1

Set up Obsidian and Daily Notes

- Obsidian stores notes in local folders called “vaults”
- To set up your journal, create a new vault
- Enable the Daily Notes core plug-in
- Select a date format and turn on “Open Daily note on startup” in the Daily Notes core plug-in settings
- Create a folder in your vault called “Journal” to store your journaling notes

Task 2

Create a Daily Notes template

- Create a “Templates” folder in your vault to store your template
- Create a new note in the Templates folder to use as a template
- Include “Today’s To-Do List”, “Ongoing Projects Tasks”, “Notes of the day” and “Thoughts” sections to track and journal your activities and reflections
- Use ## markdown to create Heading 2 blocks, add a # for each level you want to add, for example ### will generate a Heading 3
- You can use the UI to create Heading blocks, right-click and select “Paragraph > Heading 2”

Task 3

Track Tasks with Task Lists

- Use - [] markdown syntax to create a checklist (task list)
- You can use UI to insert a task list: right-click and select “Insert > Task List”
- Create a Projects folder and an ongoing projects note within
- Embed the central ongoing projects note using the syntax ![[note_name]]
- To embed only a section, use the syntax ![[note_name#section_heading]]
- Use the graph view to visualize the connections between notes

Optional ungraded practice activity

Task 4

Integrate Journaling Prompts and Reflection tags

- Use the _text_ syntax or the UI (right-click and select “Format > Italic”) to add italic text
- Add journaling prompts such as “What were my wins today?”, “What challenges did I face?”, “What did I learn today?”, “What is one thing I could improve on tomorrow?” to foster

- reflection, self-analysis, self-awareness and actions
- Add tags using the # sign, for example “#wins” to mark the points of reflection for later reporting

Task 5

Analyze journal entries using tags and queries

- The Schedule section allows you to schedule events on the calendar.
- Any To-do list task that has a due date, will be reflected on the schedule.
- You can add events such as presentations, internal meetings, client presentations or key project milestones.

Cumulative activity